Literal segments and route parameters are the two cornerstones of ASP.NET Core route templates. With these two concepts, it's possible to build all manner of URLs for your application. In the remainder of section 6.3 we'll look at additional features that let you have optional URL segments, provide default values when a segment isn't specified, and place additional constraints on the values that are valid for a given route parameter.

6.3.2 Using optional and default values

In section 6.3.1 you saw a simple route template with a literal segment and two required routing parameters. Figure 6.6 shows a more complex route that uses several additional features.

The literal `product` segment and the required `{category}` parameter are the same as those in in figure 6.6. The `{name}` parameter looks similar, but it has a default value specified for it by `=all`. If the URL doesn't contain a segment corresponding to the `{name}` parameter, the router will use the `all` value instead.

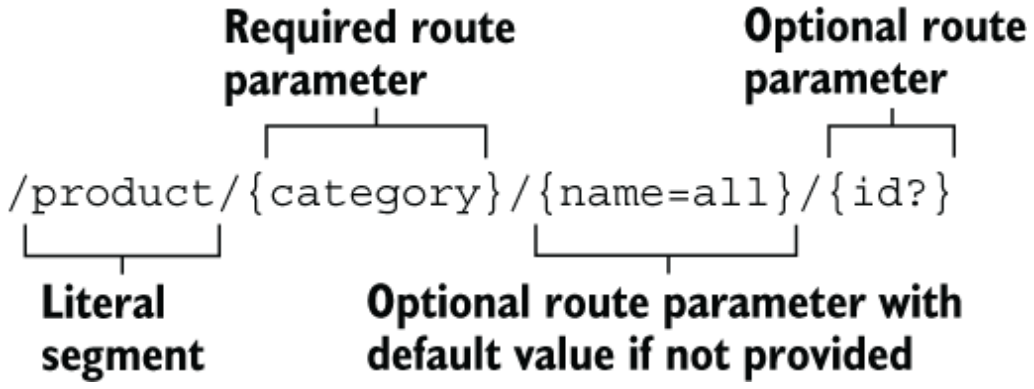


Figure 6.6 A more complex route template showing literal segments, named route parameters, optional parameters, and default values.